

Word family: **courtesy / courtesies / courteous / courteously / discourteous / discourteously / discourtesy**

Base word: courtesy

Plural: courtesies

Related forms: courteous, courteously, discourteous, discourteously, discourtesy

Lower-priority forms: courteousness, uncourteous

Part of speech: noun (名詞) ; also used attributively before nouns in compounds such as

courtesy car

Your sentence:

> “A city already under pressure should not normalize behaviour that erodes everyday
courtesy.”

Meaning in this passage

Here, **courtesy** means **polite, respectful, considerate behaviour toward other people in ordinary daily interactions**.

The writer means that if people repeatedly put their own convenience ahead of other customers' needs, everyday habits of politeness and consideration may gradually weaken.

繁體中文： **禮貌；禮讓；日常待人接物時對別人的尊重和體諒**

中文翻譯：

> “...behaviour that erodes everyday **courtesy**.”

「.....會逐漸侵蝕日常**禮貌 / 禮讓精神**的行為。」

Here:

everyday courtesy = 日常生活中顧及別人、尊重別人、不給他人造成不必要麻煩的基本禮貌

A. COURTESY = POLITE / RESPECTFUL BEHAVIOUR

1. **courtesy = polite and respectful behaviour (禮貌) — 禮貌；禮節；禮讓**

This is the exact passage sense.

Practice 1 — Original

> “Shared spaces depend on everyday **courtesy**.”

「共用空間有賴日常的**禮貌與禮讓**。」

Practice 2

> “He treated everyone with **courtesy**.”

「他以**禮貌**的態度對待每一個人。」

Practice 3

> “Courtesy costs nothing.”

「**待人有禮**並不需要付出甚麼代價。」

****courtesy = 在待人接物時表現出的尊重、禮貌和體諒****

Common:

- * show courtesy
- * treat someone with courtesy
- * basic courtesy
- * everyday courtesy
- * mutual courtesy

2. ****common courtesy = basic politeness everyone is normally expected to show (基本禮貌) — 基本禮貌；做人最基本的禮數****

Practice 4

> “It is common **courtesy** to let people leave the train before you board.”

「先讓乘客下車再上車是最基本的**禮貌**。」

Practice 5

> “He did not even have the common **courtesy** to reply.”

「他連回覆一下這種**基本禮貌**都沒有。」

****common courtesy = 社會交往中一般人合理應有的最基本禮貌****

This is a very important fixed expression.

3. **courtesy = consideration for other people's convenience (體諒) — 顧及；體貼；禮讓**

Courtesy is not merely saying:

> please / thank you.

It can involve changing your behaviour so you do not inconvenience other people.

Practice 6

> “Please show some **courtesy** to people waiting for a table.”

「請**顧及 / 禮讓**正在等座位的人。」

Practice 7

> “Keeping your voice down is a matter of **courtesy**.”

「降低聲量是一種**顧及他人的基本禮貌**。」

This is especially close to the editorial passage.

B. A COURTESY = A POLITE ACT OR FAVOUR

4. **a courtesy = a polite or considerate act (禮貌之舉) — 禮貌行為；體貼之舉**

Here **courtesy** becomes countable.

Practice 8

> “Sending a short reply would be a simple **courtesy**.”

「簡單回覆一下是一個基本的**禮貌之舉**。」

Practice 9

> “They extended every **courtesy** to their guests.”

「他們對客人**禮數周到 / 盡力以禮相待**。」

a courtesy = 某一次具體的禮貌、體貼或友善行為

5. **courtesies** = polite acts/formalities (禮節) — 禮節；客套

Plural **courtesies** often refers to polite social formalities.

Practice 10

> “They exchanged the usual **courtesies** before the meeting.”

「會議前，他們互相作了慣常的**禮貌寒暄 / 客套**。」

Practice 11

> “After a few formal courtesies, the discussion began.”

「幾句正式**寒暄客套**後，討論便開始了。」

exchange courtesies = 互相問候、寒暄、作禮貌性交流

C. **AS A COURTESY**

6. **as a courtesy** = as a polite favour, not because it is required (出於禮貌) — 作為禮貌；出於好意

Practice 12

> “We contacted residents in advance as a **courtesy**.”

「我們**出於禮貌 / 好意**，事先通知居民。」

Practice 13

> “The company refunded the charge as a **courtesy**.”

「公司**基於善意 / 作為禮貌性安排**退回了該筆費用。」

This often implies:

> **we were not strictly required to do this.**

That nuance is important in business/customer-service English.

7. **as a courtesy to someone = specifically to avoid inconveniencing them**

> “As a courtesy to other passengers, please keep phone calls brief.”

「**為了顧及其他乘客**，請把電話通話保持簡短。」

Very common in notices and announcements.

D. **OUT OF COURTESY**

8. **out of courtesy = because politeness required it (出於禮貌)**

Practice 14

> “I stayed until the end out of **courtesy**.”

「我**出於禮貌**留到最後。」

Practice 15

> “She listened out of courtesy, although she disagreed.”

「雖然她不同意，但她**出於禮貌**還是聽了下去。」

E. **HAVE THE COURTESY TO...**

9. **have the courtesy to do something = be polite enough to do it (至少有禮貌去.....)**

Often used critically.

Practice 16

> “You could at least have the **courtesy** to tell me you were going to be late.”

「你至少也應該有這點**禮貌**，告訴我你會遲到。」

Practice 17

> “He did not even have the courtesy to apologize.”

「他甚至連道歉這點**基本禮貌**也沒有。」

This often implies:

> **the speaker thinks the behaviour was disrespectful.**

10. **do someone the courtesy of doing something = show them the respect of doing it**

Practice 18

> “Please do me the **courtesy of** listening before you answer.”

「請至少**尊重我一下**，先聽完再回答。」

Somewhat formal and often mildly reproachful.

F. **COURTESY OF**

This expression has several important uses.

11. **courtesy of someone = provided, supplied, or paid for by them (由.....提供) **

Practice 19

> “Refreshments are provided courtesy of the hotel.”

「茶點由酒店**提供 / 贊助**。」

Practice 20

> “The photographs appear courtesy of the museum.”

「照片由博物館**提供 / 授權使用**。」

Especially common in:

* acknowledgements

* credits

* media

* events

* sponsorship

12. **photo/image courtesy of X = image supplied or permitted by X (圖片鳴謝 / 來源) **

Very common in publishing.

> “Photo courtesy of the National Museum.”

≈

「照片由國家博物館**提供 / 授權使用**。」

The phrase can indicate:

* source;

* permission;

* contribution.

Exact rights arrangements cannot be inferred from the phrase alone.

13. **by courtesy of = with the permission/help of (正式) — 承蒙……允許 / 協助**

Practice 21

> “The manuscript is reproduced by courtesy of the library.”

「這份手稿承蒙圖書館**允許 / 協助**而得以重印。」

More formal than ordinary:

> courtesy of.

14. **courtesy of X = because of X, often ironically (多虧 / 拜……所賜) **

A highly useful figurative extension.

Practice 22

> “We spent three hours at the airport, courtesy of a delayed flight.”

「**拜航班延誤所賜**，我們在機場待了三個小時。」

Practice 23

> “My shoes are soaked, courtesy of the rain.”

「**拜這場雨所賜**，我的鞋全濕了。」

This can be neutral, but is often mildly ironic or sarcastic.

Meaning:

> **as a result of / thanks to**

G. ATTRIBUTIVE **COURTESY** = PROVIDED FREE AS A SERVICE

15. **courtesy + noun = provided free for customers/guests as a convenience (免費提供) **

A major institutional extension.

Here **courtesy** works attributively before another noun.

The broad meaning is:

> **provided as a service or favour rather than separately charged**

16. **courtesy car / courtesy vehicle = temporary replacement vehicle (代用車) — 免費代用車**

Especially common in British automotive English.

Practice 24

> “The garage provided a **courtesy car** while mine was being repaired.”

「我的車維修期間，車房提供了一部**免費代用車**。」

Usually:

> supplied temporarily to a customer while their own vehicle is unavailable.

17. **courtesy bus / courtesy shuttle = free transport service (免費接駁車) **

Practice 25

> “A courtesy shuttle runs between the hotel and the airport.”

「酒店與機場之間有**免費接駁車**。」

Often equivalent to:

> complimentary shuttle.

18. **courtesy phone / courtesy telephone = free-use telephone (免費電話) **

Traditionally found in:

- * airports
- * hotels
- * hospitals
- * transport terminals

Example:

> “Use the courtesy phone to contact reception.”

「使用**免費服務電話**聯絡接待處。」

Less prominent today because mobile phones are widespread, but genuine.

19. **courtesy copy = free complimentary copy (贈閱本) **

A copy of a:

- * book
- * document
- * publication

provided without charge as a professional/polite gesture.

繁體中文： **贈閱本 / 免費提供的副本**

20. **courtesy light = automatically provided convenience light (車輛 / 建築) — 車廂禮儀燈 /

門控燈**

In vehicles, a **courtesy light** commonly means an interior light that illuminates automatically, for example when a door is opened.

Depending on region/context:

> 車廂燈 / 門控照明燈

This is established automotive terminology.

H. **COURTESY CALL**

21. **courtesy call = polite/professional telephone call (禮貌性電話) **

Practice 26

> “I’m making a **courtesy call** to confirm tomorrow’s appointment.”

「我打這通**禮貌性確認電話**是想確認明天的預約。」

This can be used for:

- * checking in;
- * confirming;
- * maintaining a relationship;
- * notifying someone politely.

22. **courtesy call = formal polite visit (禮節性拜訪) **

In diplomatic, military, institutional, and traditional business contexts:

> a courtesy call

can mean:

> **禮節性拜訪 / 禮貌拜會**

Practice 27

> “The delegation paid a courtesy call on the director.”

「代表團**禮節性拜會**了主管。」

So **courtesy call** is not necessarily a telephone call.

Context determines the meaning.

23. **courtesy visit = 禮節性拜訪**

Similar to #22:

> “The ambassador made a courtesy visit.”

「大使作了一次**禮節性拜訪**。」

The primary purpose is maintaining formal relations rather than conducting substantive negotiations.

I. **COURTESY TITLE**

24. **courtesy title = title used by custom/politeness rather than as a substantive legal office (禮貌稱謂 / 禮遇頭銜)**

There are two important applications.

Ordinary forms of address

Terms such as:

* Mr

* Mrs

* Ms

* Miss

may be described in some style/linguistic contexts as **courtesy titles**.

Meaning:

> polite title placed before a person's name.

25. **courtesy title — aristocratic usage (禮遇頭銜)**

In systems of nobility, especially British usage, **courtesy title** can mean a title used socially by certain relatives of a peer even though the person does not hold that peerage title in their own right.

The exact rules are complex and depend on rank, relationship, and convention.

This is a genuine specialist institutional sense.

J. **COURTESY NAME**

26. **courtesy name** = traditional secondary personal name in East Asian history (字 / 表字)

In historical Chinese culture, a **courtesy name** commonly translates:

> **字**

a name adopted/given around adulthood and used in appropriate social contexts in addition to the personal given name.

Example:

> Confucius's courtesy name was Zhongni.

This term also appears when discussing related naming traditions elsewhere in East Asia.

courtesy name ≠ nickname

It had a formal social/cultural function.

K. **COURTESY FLAG**

27. **courtesy flag** = foreign national flag flown as a sign of respect by a visiting vessel (航海)
— 禮儀旗 / 東道國國旗

In maritime practice, a visiting vessel may fly the host country's national flag as a **courtesy flag**.

繁體中文： 禮儀旗；訪港 / 訪國船舶懸掛的東道國國旗

This is a genuine nautical compound.

L. **COURTESY RUNNER — SPORTS**

28. **courtesy runner = special substitute runner allowed under certain baseball/softball rules (棒球 / 壘球) — 代跑球員**

In some baseball/softball rule systems, a **courtesy runner** may run for a specified player, often under special rules that do not function exactly like an ordinary substitution.

The precise rules vary by league/competition.

This is specialist sports terminology.

M. **COURTESY CLERK**

29. **courtesy clerk = supermarket customer-service/bagging employee (美式零售) **

In some American supermarkets, **courtesy clerk** is a job title for an employee performing customer-support tasks such as:

- * bagging groceries;
- * collecting carts;
- * helping customers;
- * maintaining checkout areas.

****繁體中文：可按實際職務譯作 顧客服務店員 / 包裝店員****

Regional/institutional term.

N. **COURTESY FLUSH — INFORMAL**

30. **courtesy flush = flushing a toilet during use to reduce odour (美式非正式) **

An informal/humorous expression.

Meaning:

> flush before finishing, typically to reduce unpleasant smell for other people.

****繁體中文：可解釋為 為顧及他人而中途沖廁****

Not formal vocabulary, but it is an established colloquial expression.

O. ****PROFESSIONAL COURTESY****

31. ****professional courtesy = respectful accommodation between professionals (專業禮讓) ****

This can mean:

> respectful, cooperative treatment extended between people in the same or related professions.

Practice 28

> “She informed the other doctor as a matter of professional courtesy.”

「她基於****專業禮貌 / 同行禮儀****通知了另一位醫生。」

32. ****professional courtesy = reduced/free professional service, traditionally (專業優惠) ****

Historically and in some professions, ****professional courtesy**** can also refer to providing professional services:

- * free;
- * at reduced charge;
- * as a favour

to fellow professionals or their families.

This usage varies by profession and may be subject to institutional, ethical, or billing rules.

P. ****COURTESY NOTICE****

33. ****courtesy notice / courtesy reminder = informal advance notification (禮貌性通知 / 提示) ****

A ****courtesy notice**** is commonly a notice sent:

- * as a reminder;
- * before stronger/formal action;
- * as helpful information.

Example:

> “This email is a courtesy reminder that your payment is due next week.”

「這封電郵是提醒你下星期付款到期的**禮貌性通知**。」

Important:

> **courtesy notice** does not necessarily mean the notice has no legal significance.

That depends on the actual document/context.

Q. **COURTESY SEATING / PRIORITY AS A COURTESY**

The adjective can productively appear in institutional phrases meaning:

> provided voluntarily for convenience/respect.

Examples can include:

- * courtesy seating
- * courtesy transportation
- * courtesy service
- * courtesy reminder

Not all are fixed dictionary compounds, so they should be interpreted compositionally rather than treated as independent lexical meanings.

R. **COURTEOUS**

34. **courteous = polite, respectful, and considerate (有禮貌的) — 有禮的 ; 彬彬有禮的 ; 謙恭的**

Practice 29

> “The staff were friendly and **courteous**.”

「職員友善而且**有禮貌**。」

Practice 30

> “Please remain courteous even when you disagree.”

「即使不同意，也請保持**有禮**。」

****courteous = 在說話和行為上尊重別人、符合良好禮貌規範****

35. ****courteous to/towards someone****

> “He was courteous to every customer.”

「他對每位顧客都很****有禮****。」

Both:

* courteous to

* courteous towards

are possible.

36. ****courteous manner/tone/response****

Common:

* courteous manner

* courteous reply

* courteous tone

* courteous service

This word often describes professional customer service.

S. ****COURTEOUSLY****

37. ****courteously = politely/respectfully (有禮地) ****

Practice 31

> “She ****courteously**** asked them to lower their voices.”

「她很****有禮貌地****請他們降低聲量。」

A normal adverb, though less frequent than phrases like:

> politely

> in a courteous manner.

T. ****DISCOURTEOUS****

38. ****discourteous = impolite; lacking courtesy (無禮的) — 無禮的 ; 失禮的****

Practice 32

> “It would be ****discourteous**** to ignore the other guests.”

「完全不理會其他客人會很****無禮****。」

Practice 33

> “His reply was unnecessarily discourteous.”

「他的回覆沒有必要地顯得很****失禮****。」

This is more formal than:

> rude.

U. ****DISCOURTESY****

39. ****discourtesy = lack of politeness / an impolite act (無禮) — 無禮 ; 失禮行為****

Practice 34

> “Leaving without thanking the host was a ****discourtesy****.”

「離開時沒有向主人道謝是一種****失禮行為****。」

Can be:

Uncountable

> discourtesy toward customers

= 對顧客無禮

Countable

> a discourtesy

= 一次失禮行為

40. **discourteously = in an impolite way (無禮地) **

> “He spoke discourteously to the receptionist.”

「他對接待員說話十分**無禮**。」

V. **UNCourteous**

41. **uncourteous = not courteous (不禮貌的) **

This exists but is much less common than:

> **discourteous**

For a learner database:

discourteous should be prioritized.

W. IMPORTANT DISTINCTIONS

courtesy vs politeness

politeness

is the broad quality of behaving politely.

courtesy

often emphasizes socially considerate, respectful conduct toward others.

They overlap heavily.

> politeness in language

> courtesy toward other passengers

courtesy vs manners

manners

means conventional ways of behaving politely.

> good manners

> table manners

courtesy

means the broader respectful consideration shown to others.

A person may know formal manners but still behave without real consideration.

courtesy vs etiquette

etiquette

= system/rules of socially appropriate behaviour.

courtesy

= the actual polite consideration shown.

> business etiquette

> treat clients with courtesy

So:

etiquette = the rules

courtesy = the respectful behaviour

courtesy vs consideration

This is particularly important because both occur in your passage.

consideration

= thinking about other people's needs, feelings, rights, and inconvenience.

courtesy

= polite/respectful behaviour that often results from that consideration.

Example:

> You consider that someone is elderly and tired.

That is **consideration**.

> You offer them your seat.

That is an act of **courtesy**.

They overlap, but this distinction is useful.

courtesy vs civility

civility

= polite, restrained behaviour, especially despite disagreement or tension.

courtesy

= polite consideration in social interaction more generally.

> political debate conducted with civility

> everyday courtesy toward customers

courtesy vs respect

respect

is an attitude of valuing another person, their rights, status, or qualities.

courtesy

is often the behaviour through which respect is expressed.

You can disagree strongly with someone while still treating them with courtesy.

courtesy vs kindness

kindness

means benevolence/helpfulness.

courtesy

means politeness/respect.

Holding a door may be both.

Giving someone major financial help is kindness but not necessarily “courtesy.”

courtesy vs favour

favour

= something helpful done for someone.

courtesy

= polite act, sometimes a small favour done because it is respectful.

> “We called you as a courtesy.”

means:

> this was a helpful/polite act, not necessarily a personal favour.

courtesy vs complimentary

In service/business contexts:

complimentary

explicitly means **free of charge**.

> complimentary breakfast

courtesy

suggests it is provided as a service/favour.

> courtesy car

Often free to the customer, but the exact commercial arrangement may depend on the provider.

courteous vs considerate

courteous

= outwardly polite and respectful.

considerate

= actively thinks about others' needs and inconvenience.

A person can be very courteous in speech yet fail to be considerate in practical behaviour.

courteous vs cordial

cordial

= warm and friendly, especially in formal relationships.

courteous

= polite and respectful.

Someone can be:

> courteous but not particularly warm.

courteous vs civil

civil

can mean minimally polite, especially when relations are strained.

courteous

often sounds more positively polite.

> “They remained civil.”

may imply they disliked each other but avoided open hostility.

****discourteous vs rude****

****rude****

is the broader and more common everyday word.

****discourteous****

is more formal and specifically means violating expectations of courtesy.

> rude remark

> discourteous treatment

X. GRAMMAR AND COUNTABILITY

****courtesy — general quality****

Usually uncountable:

> show courtesy

> treat people with courtesy

> common courtesy

****a courtesy — individual polite act****

Countable:

> a courtesy

> several courtesies

Example:

> “The call was a courtesy.”

courtesies — social formalities

Plural:

- > exchange courtesies
- > observe the usual courtesies

courtesy + noun

Attributive:

- > courtesy car
- > courtesy bus
- > courtesy phone
- > courtesy call
- > courtesy visit
- > courtesy title
- > courtesy flag

Here **courtesy** functions as a noun modifier.

Y. FAMILY MAP

Family member	Main modern meaning
-----	-----
courtesy	politeness/respect; considerate treatment; polite act
courtesies	polite acts/formalities
courteous	polite and respectful
courteously	in a polite/respectful manner
discourteous	impolite; lacking courtesy
discourteously	impolitely
discourtesy	lack of courtesy / an impolite act
uncourteous	not courteous; valid but uncommon

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
-----	-----
courtesy — general	待人時表現出的禮貌、尊重和體諒

everyday courtesy	日常生活中顧及他人、不造成不必要不便的基本禮貌	
common courtesy	社會交往中一般人應有的基本禮數	
a courtesy	一次具體的禮貌 / 體貼行為	
courtesies	社交寒暄、禮節、客套行為	
as a courtesy	出於禮貌 / 善意而做，通常並非嚴格義務	
out of courtesy	因為禮貌上的考量	
have the courtesy to	至少有基本禮貌去做某事	
do someone the courtesy of	出於尊重而至少為某人做某事	
courtesy of X — supplied by	由 X 提供 / 贊助 / 授權	
courtesy of X — causal/ironic	拜 X 所賜；由 X 所造成	
by courtesy of	承蒙……允許 / 協助	
courtesy car	維修期間等免費 / 臨時提供的代用車	
courtesy bus/shuttle	免費接駁交通	
courtesy phone	免費供顧客 / 訪客使用的服務電話	
courtesy copy	免費提供的贈閱本 / 副本	
courtesy light	車門等操作時自動亮起的便利照明 / 車廂燈	
courtesy call — telephone	為保持禮貌、確認或關係而打的禮貌性電話	
courtesy call/visit — formal	外交 / 機構場合的禮節性拜訪	
courtesy title — address	出於社交禮貌使用的稱謂	
courtesy title — nobility	按慣例使用、而非本人實質持有的禮遇頭銜	
courtesy name	東亞傳統文化中的「字 / 表字」	
courtesy flag	訪問外國港口時出於禮儀懸掛的東道國國旗	
courtesy runner	某些棒球 / 壘球規則下的特別代跑球員	
courtesy clerk	某些美式超市中的顧客服務 / 包裝店員	
courtesy flush	為減少氣味、顧及他人而中途沖廁；非正式	
professional courtesy	同行之間的專業禮讓；亦可指傳統的同業優惠服務	
courtesy notice	作為提醒 / 善意安排而發出的禮貌性通知	
courteous	有禮貌、尊重並以合宜態度對待他人的	
courteously	有禮貌地	
discourteous	缺乏禮貌、失禮的	
discourtesy	無禮 / 一次失禮行為	

For your original sentence

> “...behaviour that ****erodes everyday courtesy****.”

The exact meaning is:

****courtesy = 人們在共用公共 / 商業空間中願意互相禮讓、尊重別人的需要，並避免自己的行為給其他人造成不必要麻煩的基本社交習慣****

So:

> ****erode everyday courtesy****

= ****逐漸侵蝕人們日常互相尊重和禮讓的習慣****

There is a useful chain across the words you have just curated:

> **consideration**

> = 心裡顧及別人的需要

→ **considerate behaviour**

> = 行為上替別人着想

→ **courtesy**

> = 在日常互動中實際表現出的禮貌和尊重

→ repeated inconsiderate behaviour may **erode courtesy**

> = 逐漸削弱這些社會禮讓習慣。

For the core database, I would keep **4 major semantic branches** for **courtesy** itself:

1. **general politeness, respect, and considerate social behaviour**
2. **a specific polite act / social formality**
3. **something provided as a favour or convenience — courtesy car/call/service**
4. **courtesy of / by courtesy of — supplied by, permitted by, or figuratively caused by**

Then I would separately index the established compounds **courtesy title, courtesy name, courtesy flag, courtesy runner, professional courtesy**, plus the full **courteous / discourteous / discourtesy** family rather than hiding them under the general “politeness” heading.